“Yes.” Her mouth was dry, and her lips chapped.

The woman moved away, then returned. A hand behind her head lifted her, but her ribs stung like they were on fire. “Ouch.”

“Yes, they’re fractured. Nothing to be done but rest,” the woman said.

Cool glass on her lips, she drew the water in and down her throat. But even swallowing pinched her ribs. The woman gently put her head down, and Rose closed her eyes.

The next time she woke, all was black. The room, sky, her heart. She shivered in the cold. She could feel every part of her body except her leg. She drifted in and out of sleep. Usually, someone was there by her bedside. She sensed a presence. Heard women whispering. Felt the cool breeze enter when the window was open.

“Do you need anything?” a woman asked.

Rose opened her eyes. “Who are you?”

“My name is Johanna.”

“Are you always here?”

“I come every night.”

“Just you?”

“Oh no, all of us. It’s safe here.” She took a breath. “And we look after Hans.”

She remembered he’d changed his name. What was hers? She didn’t care. She would leave. The war was over. So was her promise.

“Do you know what happened?” Johanna said.

“A bomb dropped.”

“Yes. And after?”

“No. I don’t have any memory. Just falling and waking up here.” She swallowed. “How long has it been?”

“Three months.”

Rose looked outside. It was nearly twilight but the coppery glow she’d glimpsed before had gone. The sky was now as gray as an old tin pot. She could feel the crisp air coming in through the open window. She’d missed summer. Had she also missed her chance? “How did I get here?”

“Hans brought you.”

“He found me?”

“Yes. Would you like to speak with him?”

No. She wanted to be free and far from him.